2. Which soil is predominantly found in the districts of Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga and Champaran?

(a) Black soil (b) Newer alluvium
(c) Older alluvium (d) Red soil
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Newer alluvium soil is found in the districts of Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga and Champaran. Newer alluvium soil (khadar) is created by the decomposition of sediments from the flood waters brought by the rivers Gandak, Burhi Gandak, Bagmati etc., every year. This soil helps in the production of crops like paddy, wheat, Jute and Sugarcane.

3. Old Kachhari clay of Gangetic plain is called

(a) Bhabar (b) Bhangar
(c) Khadar (d) Khondolyte

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Geologically, the alluvium of the Great Plain of India is divided into newer or younger Khadar and older Bhangar soils. Bhangar is found on the higher level beyond the reach of floods. Bhangar soil contains calcareous concretions and is generally pale reddish brown in colour.

4. Which soil particles are present in loamy soils?

(a) Sand particles (b) Clay particles
(c) Silt particles (d) All types of particles

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Generally, Loam soil has 40% sand particles, 40% clay particles and 20% silt particles. Thus, option (d) is correct.

Soils: Miscellaneous

1. Karewas soils, which are useful for the cultivation of Zafran (a local variety of saffron), are found

(a) Kashmir Himalaya
(b) Garhwal Himalaya
(c) Nepal Himalaya
(d) Eastern Himalaya
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Karewa soil is found in the Kashmir Valley and is used for growing local saffron called Zafran.

2. For which cultivation Karewas are famous?

(a) Banana (b) Saffron
(c) Mango (d) Grapes
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

Karewa glacier, clay and other substances is deposited as a thick layer on the glacier Karewa, is famous for the cultivation of Zayran (native saffron)

3. Soil water available to plants is maximum in :

(a) clay soil (b) silty soil
(c) sandy soil (d) loamy soil

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Clay soil has the highest water retention capacity. Therefore soil water available to plants is maximum in it. Clay soil has less than 50% silt, 50% clay and some amount of sand. This soil slows air ventilation, due to which it sustains water.

Soil Erosion and Conservation

1. When running water cuts through clayey soils and makes deep channels, they lead to

(a) gully erosion (b) sheet erosion
(c) deforestation (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 11-12) 15-12-2023

Ans. (a)

The denudation of the soil cover and subsequent washing down is described as soil erosion. The running water cuts through the clayey soils and makes deep channels as gullies. This leads to gully erosion. Sometimes water flows as a sheet over large areas down a slope. In such cases, the topsoil is washed away. This is known as sheet erosion.

2. Soil erosion can be checked by

(a) Excess grazing
(b) Removal of plants
(c) Afforestation
(d) Increasing number of birds

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Soil conservation includes all the methods to check soil erosion and maintain soil fertility. Some of the effective ways to prevent soil erosion are – afforestation, contour tillage, banning shifting cultivation, etc.